

THE SILICON SYNDICATE

Silicon Syndicate is a business strategy and crisis-management competition where teams manage a fictional tech company, make strategic decisions, and respond to unexpected challenges. It tests business judgement, adaptability, and decision-making under pressure.

ROUND 1: THE BOARD RESOLUTION

TIME DURATION: 2 HOURS

DELEGATE CAP: 3

Teams act as a company's Board of Directors and receive an AI-related business decision along with basic company and financial data. They analyse the costs, expected returns, risks and overall business impact, then prepare a short Executive Strategy Document explaining their decision. Partway through, a Competitive Development is revealed, such as a competitor making a major AI investment or changing its market strategy. Teams then have to reconsider their original plan and can maintain, modify or reverse it. Finally, they present their decision to a Shareholder Panel and defend their financial and strategic reasoning under questioning.

Judging Criteria:

- Strength and commercial logic of the final resolution
- Use of financial and market information
- Understanding of AI-related business impact and risk
- Ability to adapt when the competitive position changes
- Board coordination and defense under shareholder questioning

Round 2: Corporate Crisis Room

TIME DURATION: 2 HOURS

DELEGATE CAP: 3

Teams act as a company's Crisis Management Task Force during a serious AI-related emergency. They first receive an incomplete crisis situation and create an immediate response covering operations, financial risk, technical action and public communication. Partway through, a Crisis Escalation is revealed which makes their original solution more difficult or costly. A final development then forces them into a difficult trade-off where every option carries some financial, legal, operational or reputational risk. Teams finish with a Crisis Response Plan, Press Statement and Board Briefing, then defend how and why their strategy changed as the crisis developed.

Judging Criteria

- Practicality of the crisis response and business continuity plan
- Financial, operational and reputational risk management
- Appropriate use of AI-based solutions and technical controls
- Quality of communication and press response
- Adaptability based on new evidence
- Ability to defend difficult trade-offs under questioning

Round 3: The Silicon Venture Pitch

TIME DURATION: 2 HOURS

DELEGATE CAP: 3

In the final round, teams act as entrepreneurs pitching an AI-driven business model or enterprise transformation strategy to a panel of Venture Capitalists. The pitch must go beyond concept-level ideas to focus on key commercial metrics: Target Market Sizing (TAM/SAM/SOM), Value Proposition, Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC), Revenue Model & ROI, and Competitive Moat. The panel of judges will stress-test each team's unit economics, operational feasibility, and market-entry strategy.

Judging Criteria:

- Market Opportunity & Innovation: Viability and scalability of the proposed business model in a real-world market.
- Financial & Commercial Logic: Strength of unit economics, ROI projections, and go-to-market GTM strategy.
- Pitch Execution & VC Defense: Professionalism, clarity, and handling of sharp financial and strategic questioning.

Note:

The proceedings of each round may be altered at the sole discretion of the category head.